

Mihajlo Stevanović

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MSc MVA student, ENS Paris-Saclay | French Government Scholar (BGF)

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Île-de-France (Paris region), France

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Robot learning (imitation and reinforcement learning), world models, contact-rich and dynamic manipulation, trajectory optimization and model-based control, sim-to-real transfer.

SKILLS

Robotics	NVIDIA Isaac Sim/Lab, OpenUSD, ROS 1 (Noetic), ROS 2 (Jazzy, Kilted), Gazebo, ABB RobotStudio
ML	PyTorch, ACT, Diffusion Policy, reinforcement learning, LoRA fine-tuning, NumPy, SciPy
Programming	Python, C, C++, MATLAB, Bash; Git, Docker, Linux (Ubuntu 20.04/24.04)

EDUCATION

- École Normale Supérieure (ENS) Paris-Saclay** Gif-sur-Yvette, France
 - MSc (M2) MVA – Mathématiques, Vision, Apprentissage* *Sep 2026 – Aug 2027*
 - Fall courses:** Robotics · Convex Optimization · Probabilistic Graphical Models & Deep Generative Models · Optimal Transport for ML · Foundations of LLMs
- University of Belgrade, School of Electrical Engineering** Belgrade, Serbia
 - BSc Electrical Engineering and Computing – Signals and Systems (240 ECTS); GPA: 9.11/10* *Oct 2022 – Jul 2026*
 - Selected courses:** Robotics & Automation (10) · Autonomous Mobile Robots (10) · Control Systems 1 & 2 (10) · System Modeling & Identification (10) · Stochastic Systems & Estimation (9) · Neural Networks (10)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Robotic Table Tennis: Ball Interception with a Franka Panda (in progress)** Belgrade, Serbia
 - ETF Robotics Laboratory | Franka Emika Panda (7-DoF), ROS 1 Noetic, Gazebo, MoveIt* *Aug 2026 – present*
 - Built a Gazebo setup on the real robot's franka_ros interfaces (CAD paddle, ball calibrated to real rebound). A MoveIt interceptor reaches within 1–2 cm of the predicted contact point but too slowly for the ball's flight, so I am developing a nonlinear MPC (CasADi/IPOPT, acados) that times the paddle to the ball's predicted arrival.
- BSc Thesis – Limits of Imitation Learning for High-Precision Manipulation**  [Code](#)
 - ETF Robotics Laboratory, University of Belgrade – Advisor: Prof. Kosta Jovanović* *2026*
 - Generated 30,290 expert demonstrations of fiber-optic (SFP) connector insertion with a UR5e arm in NVIDIA Isaac Lab and trained ACT and Diffusion Policy with an auxiliary phase-prediction head.
 - Data-scaling study (1k/10k/30k demos): lateral error is the main obstacle; more data cut DP's median **lateral error** $3.5\times$ (41.2 → 11.8 mm), still far from the millimetre precision insertion requires.
- Robotics Research Intern – ETF Robotics Laboratory** Belgrade, Serbia
 - School of Electrical Engineering, University of Belgrade* *Nov 2025 – Jul 2026*
 - Developed IL/RL policies for cable insertion in Isaac Lab for the [AI for Industry Challenge](#) (Intrinsic & Open Robotics); built OpenUSD scenes and a containerized ROS 2 (Kilted Kaiju)/Gazebo sim-to-real environment.
- PSIML – Practical Seminar in Machine Learning** Zrenjanin, Serbia  [Code](#)
 - Selected Participant – Machine Learning Summer School* *Aug 2026*
 - One of the most selective ML summer schools in the region; mentoring by researchers from Microsoft, ETH Zürich, INSAIT, Tenstorrent.
 - Built an **action-conditioned video world model** for robot manipulation: fine-tuned Wan2.1 (via minWM) with **LoRA** on the BAIR robot-pushing dataset; on 256 held-out scenes it consistently followed the commanded motion direction (NVIDIA A100 cluster).

PUBLICATIONS

- D. Seničić, F. Bečanović, D. Janković, L. Veličković, **M. Stevanović**, K. Jovanović, “Creating a virtual environment to bridge the gap between simulation and reality in robot assembly tasks,” in *Proc. LXX ETRAN Conference*, Srebrno jezero, Serbia, pp. 173–177, Jun 2026. ISBN 978-86-6200-075-0. [\[Paper\]](#) (in Serbian)

HONORS & AWARDS

- French Government Scholarship (Bourse du Gouvernement Français, BGF)** – M2 MVA, ENS Paris-Saclay *2026*
- 3rd Place**, Play With IT Agri-Bot Hackathon (Embassy of Italy, Belgrade) – Team Lead *Jun 2026*

TEACHING

- Teaching Assistant (Demonstrator)** – laboratory sessions for 4 undergraduate courses Belgrade, Serbia
 - School of Electrical Engineering, University of Belgrade* *Nov 2025 – Jul 2026*

ADDITIONAL

Languages	Serbian (native), English (C1, TOEFL iBT 90), German (B1), French (A2)
Interests	Clarinet, classical literature, Argentine tango, street workout